AI INSTITUTE #AIISC
UNIVERSITY OF SOUTH CAROLINA

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CSCE 190: Computing in the Modern World

Classes 10 & 11–
Career and Highlighting for Prof. Success

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Carolinian Creed: "I will practice personal and academic integrity."

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Outline

- Introduction Section
  - Recap from Last Class
- Main Section
  - Highlighting Achievements
  - Elevator Pitch
  - LinkedIn
  - Resume / CV/ Biodata
- Conclusion Section
  - Ask Me Anything



Introduction Section

Recap from Last Lecture - Class 9

We talked about

- Problem Solving Process
- **Validating the Problem**
  - **Creating Requirements and Specifications**
  - **Testing – Concepts and Activities**
- Problem Solving with
  - Computing (Software, Hardware, Services)
  - GenAI
- Selecting Problems that Matter

Assignment 9: Same for All in a Team

- Group 4-5 students
- Discuss a problem category
- Decide on a problem – see ***problems that matter***
- Solve for your problem
  - The group will have one solution plan
  - Add your statement to your GitHub in a sub-folder called 'assignment-9'
    - Do mention all the students in your group

- Create prompt(s)
  - Record response(s) and iterate, if necessary
- Discuss prompts and responses
  - Verify (with specification, test plans)
  - Validate (with requirements, test plans)
  - Consider both functional specification and non-functional aspects
- Re-think solving strategy
  - LLM choice(s)
  - Prompt strategies
  - Solving approach

See sample testcases at: https://github.com/biplav-s/course-cmw-f26/tree/main/software-dev

Computing in the News - 1

1. **Safe AI for Seniors 2026, article:** https://www.southcarolinapublicradio.org/sc-news/2026-10-23/usc-hosts-workshop-to-help-older-adults-understand-ai, **Video and article**: https://www.wspa.com/news/state-news/usc-helps-seniors-learn-how-to-use-artificial-intelligence/, Oct 2026

- AI may be child's play with easy access
- But safety for vulnerable societal segments is a serious issue

2. **Funds**: **Using AI to protect from future bio-threats**, https://news.sky.com/story/uk-pledges-to-spend-600m-to-defend-against-ai-health-and-security-threats-13602935, Oct 2026

- AI itself is a threat but also a means to improve security
- Pounds 600m investment

3. **Microsoft offers voluntary buyouts to 60,000 employees as AI leads to efficiency push,** https://www.cnbc.com/2026/10/26/microsoft-msft-voluntary-buyouts.html, Oct 2026

- More uncertainty due to increasing costs

Computing in the News - 2

1. **Swedish Government Blocks ChatGPT, Claude,** **article:** https://www.euronews.com/2026/10/26/swedish-government-blocks-chatgpt-and-claude-heres-why, Oct 2026

- Employees can no longer use browser-based versions of OpenAI's ChatGPT or Anthropic's Claude on their work computers following security concerns relating to the processing of sensitive data.
- Microsoft's Copilot, which has passed a security screening process and is covered by a security agreement between the US company and the Swedish government, is being recommended as an alternative

2. **New York enacts ban on 'unsafe' chatbot behavior with kids as states push AI regulation boundaries,** https://apnews.com/article/chatbots-ai-new-york-legislation-bans-children-03a4e090a7df1532838a5cb6f93a23ba, Oct 2026

- "With Congress doing little to regulate AI, state legislatures are packed with efforts to wield state consumer protection laws to make AI use more transparent and rein in chatbots and rogue AI frontier models"
- California and New York are leading efforts in the US

Main Section

Highlighting Achievements

- Importance
  - If you don't, who will?
  - Helps achieve appropriate recognition and success
- How much
  - Balance - not too much, not too little
  - Magic number – what people remember
    - **Seven** – [**The Magical Number Seven, Plus or Minus Two,** https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/The_Magical_Number_Seven,_Plus_or_Minus_Two]
    - **Three** – in general

Elevator Pitch

- Summarize yourself in 2-minutes
- TL; DR – Too long, didn't read, https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/TL;DR
- Question – what to cover
  - What you have done
  - What you want to do
  - Leads to interest in knowing more
- Example –
  - "I have a strong track-record of creating and using AI to solve hard business and societal problems overcoming risks, in individual and leadership capacities."

LinkedIn

- Social media for professional discussion
  - Make connections
  - Hiring and joining
  - Milestone achievements and updates
- Other abilities
  - Write posts
  - Write articles

Resumes (CV/ Biodata)

Distinctions

- Resume: created and used by an individual to present their background, skills, and accomplishments [1]. Usually 1-2 pages, but can be longer
- CV: curriculum vitae – career, qualifications, life. Can be longer than resume and terminology used in old-British influence areas [2]
- Biodata: biographical data, interchangeably with resume. Terminology used in South Asia, and can be for purposes other than career as well

Sources:

1. resume: https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/R%C3%A9sum%C3%A9
2. CV: https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Curriculum_vitae

USC’s Career Center

- Information: https://sc.edu/about/offices_and_divisions/career_center/student_career_hub/index.php
- Review USC Career Center’s deck on resume

Assignment 10: Highlight Yourself

- Objectives – *get an internship*
- Means – *have a connection*
- Information – *whom to contact and what to highlight*

- Plan an objective within the next year
- Identify how you may achieve; who can help if contacted
- Identify what information your contact may need
- Record those information (resume)
  - Background
  - Skills
  - Accomplishments
- Elevator pitch

See sample testcases at: https://github.com/biplav-s/course-cmw-f26/tree/main/software-dev

Q: One Resume or Multiple ?

- Be flexible based on objective, that may change over time
- Have a master list

Class 11: Exercise – Improving Personal Messaging

1. Get in groups of two. Let us call them **red** and **blue** members of the team
2. Phase 1: **red** reviewing **blue** member's information
3. Phase 2: **blue** reviewing **red** member's information
4. Phase 3: class recap

Phases 1 and 2

1. Understand the person's objective, means and information
2. Review the resume
3. Review the executive summary

Rubric

- Is the information easy to read (presentation) ?
- Is the information easy to understand (comprehension) ?
- Is the information relevant ?
- Is the information convincing (e.g., correct, complete) ?

Presenting Information Convincingly

- Providing evidence (e.g., Github, statistics)
- Providing 3rd party testimonial
- Mentioning logic/ process to draw conclusion; explicitly mentioning assumptions
  - Assumptions may change but process should be transparent to reader

Concluding Section

Conclusion

We talked about

- Problem Solving Process
- Validating the Problem
- Selecting Problems that Matter

Week	Content	Assignment
1	Intro, syllabus, university resources	Slack account
2	CSE majors, career paths, research areas	Write a mission statement
3	Github (account and basics) + Lab	Github account, repo
4	HTML basics, IDE (VS Code)	None
5	More HTML, CSS, Problem Solving	Update Github with CSS
6	Brainstorming, problem statement	Problem statement
7	Computing – (Software) Dev. Life Cycle	Draft Requirement, Specification
8	Computing – Testing a System	Test Plan
9	AI – LLMs/FMs, Generative AI, Issues and Challenges	Problem Solving with GenAI
10	Building a resume, LinkedIn	Draft resume in PDF
11	Review resumes	Review resumes, update Github
12	Professionalism and networking	Reconnecting with teachers and mentors
13	CSE research areas	(Finalize website)
N/A	Last day of classes: 4 Dec, 2026	**All extensions end**

Ask Me Anything